

Clemson University

From the Selected Works of Cynthia L. S. Pury

April 13, 2007

Human Strengths, Courageous Actions, and General and Personal Courage

Cynthia L. S. Pury, *Clemson University*

Robin M. Kowalski, *Clemson University*



Available at: <https://works.bepress.com/clspury/3/>

Running head: HUMAN STRENGTHS AND COURAGE

Human Strengths, Courageous Actions, and General and Personal Courage

Cynthia L. S. Pury¹ and Robin M. Kowalski

Department of Psychology, Clemson University

This is an Accepted Manuscript of an article published by Taylor & Francis Group in The Journal of Positive Psychology on 13 Apr 2007, available online at:

<http://www.tandfonline.com/doi/abs/10.1080/17439760701228813>

Pury, C. L. S., & Kowalski, R. (2007). Human strengths, courageous actions, and general and personal courage. *Journal of Positive Psychology*, 2, 120 - 128. doi: 10.1080/17439760701228813

Abstract

College students ($N = 298$, 54% female) described a time when they acted courageously, then rated their courageous action on each of 24 Values in Action (VIA) strengths (Peterson & Seligman, 2004), and on general and personal courage (Pury, Kowalski, & Spearman, 2007). Three of the four strengths of Courage -- Persistence, Integrity, and Bravery -- had mean ranks placing them in the top five strengths, along with Hope, a strength of transcendence, and Kindness, a strength of humanity. Multiple strengths were associated with higher general courage (actions that would be courageous for anyone), lower personal courage (actions that are courageous only in the context of the specific actor's life), or both. Thus, the presence of strengths seems to be more strongly associated with general courage compared to personal courage.

Human Strengths, Courageous Actions, and General and Personal Courage

Recent and ancient taxonomies of virtue include courage. In some, courage is *the* key virtue, needed for any type of virtuous action under adversity. For example, Aquinas described courage as “a general virtue, or rather a condition of each and every virtue” (quoted in Yearley, 1990, p. 130). Another philosopher, Samuel Johnson, said “courage is reckoned the greatest of all virtues; because, unless a man has that virtue, he has no security for preserving any other” (Miller, 2000, p. 5). More recently, MacIntyre (1984) questioned whether someone can be said to care about a person unless willing to face dangers on that person’s behalf. If courage really is a key virtue, one that enables other virtues to be enacted, then courageous actions should have additional noble aims beyond merely facing danger.

The Values in Action (VIA) system (Peterson & Seligman, 2004) proposes 24 character strengths, each contributing to one of six virtues (see Table 1). The VIA virtue of courage is made up of four character strengths: bravery, persistence, integrity, and vitality. Thus, a strong statement of the VIA strengths of courage is that to act courageously, one must ignore danger (bravery) and continue to act (persistence), follow one’s convictions (integrity) and act with energy and enthusiasm (vitality). If this taxonomy is correct, then these strengths of courage should describe courageous actions better than other strengths. However, many lay definitions of courage include concepts related to other strengths, such as optimism, faith, kindness, and social responsibility (Lopez, O’Byrne, & Peterson, 2003).

To date, measurement of VIA strengths has focused on stable individual differences rather than characteristics of specific actions. Yet, the “key virtue” concept suggests courage is a way to put other values into action under adversity. In other words, a courageous action may represent one or more other strengths: acting kindly, curiously, spiritually, hopefully, or in other

positive ways in the face of difficulty. If true, then individuals would likely use additional strengths beyond bravery, persistence, integrity, and vitality to describe courageous actions.

Various authors suggest there are different types of courageous action; physical courage, moral courage, and vital or psychological courage (e.g., Lopez et al., 2003; Putman, 1997). If specific strengths represent courage as a unitary construct, then they should describe all types of courageous action. If specific strengths represent specific situational demands, then they should describe only particular types of courageous actions.

Additionally, Pury, Kowalski, and Spearman (2007) distinguish between personal and general courage. *Personal courage* is the extent to which an action is courageous compared to the actor's typical behavior, and is characterized by acting despite personal limitations. *General courage* is the extent to which an action is courageous compared to the typical behavior of most others, such as acts awarded medals for heroism. Given its more public and recognizable nature, general courage may be more easily associated with various strengths than personal courage.

In the current study, we tested the relationship of VIA-defined strengths with participants' recollections of a single courageous action. Participants described a time they acted courageously, then rated it on brief descriptions of each VIA strength. To the extent that the VIA strengths of courage – bravery, integrity, persistence, and vitality – are necessary parts of courage, they should be nearly universal in describing courageous actions. Thus, they should rank higher than other strengths. To the extent that courage is a key virtue, acting as a conduit for expression of other specific virtues under adversity, other strengths should rank highly as well. Strengths that represent underlying constructs common to all types of courage should be ranked highly for physically, morally, and psychologically courageous actions; strengths that represent only some types of courageous action should be ranked higher for some types of action than for

others. Finally, because it represents societal models of courage, general courage should be more clearly connected to strengths and virtues than personal courage.

Method

Participants

Two hundred ninety eight undergraduate students (54% female) were recruited from an on-line participant pool website in Spring of 2004. All participants were enrolled in an undergraduate psychology course at a public university in the Southeastern United States, and received course credit for their participation. Mean age was 19.1 ($SD = 3.0$; range 18 - 43); ethnicity data were not collected.

Measures

Courageous action and personal and general courage. Participants were asked to *Describe a time in your life when you believe that you acted courageously.* Additionally, participants rated their action on general and personal courage (Pury et al., 2007) by rating how courageous this action was compared to their own typical actions (personal courage) and how courageous this action was compared to the actions of most other people (general courage). Following Pury et al. (2007), these ratings were made on a scale from 0 (*not at all*) to 10 (*as much as I can imagine*).

Signature strengths of courageous action. The signature strengths of each action were assessed by asking participants to rate their action on each of the VIA strengths as defined by Peterson and Seligman (2004, pp.29 – 30). Definitions of the strengths were used rather than the VIA scale itself, as we were interested in a specific action rather than more global individual differences. For example, Peterson and Seligman's definition of Kindness ("doing favors and good deeds for others; helping them; taking care of them," p. 29) was translated into three

questions: *In taking this courageous action, did you do a favor or good deed for someone else?* *In taking this courageous action, did you help someone else?* and *In taking this courageous action, did you take care of someone else?* In most cases, each question was based on a specific phrase separated by semicolons in Peterson and Seligman's definitions. Phrases encompassing clarification only (e.g., "includes physical bravery but is not limited to it") were not translated to questions. Thus, we created an 80-item scale, with 23 of the 24 subscales represented by multiple items. Creativity was represented by a single item. Sample items can be found in Table 1. As with the other ratings on the survey, participants responded to each item using an 11-point scale (*0 = not at all; 10 = as much as I can imagine*).

Procedure

Participants read an online information letter, then completed an online survey linked to the participant pool website. Submission of the survey indicated consent.

Data Analysis

We assessed "signature" virtues and strengths of the described courageous action by converting scores to ranks within individuals, similar to Park, Peterson, and Seligman (2004). Composite virtues were computed by first taking the mean of all strengths of that virtue, then ranking those means within each participant's data. Rank scores for each virtue could range from 1 (highest mean, top virtue) to 6 (lowest mean, bottom virtue). Rank scores for each strength could range from 1 (top strength) to 24 (bottom strength). Wilcoxon signed-rank z-scores with an adjusted alpha of .008 (virtues) and .002 (strengths) were used to test for differences in ranks across participants.

Narrative data were classified by type of action taken, using the same coding procedure described in Pury et al. (2007). Two trained raters classified each action into physical (e.g.,

saving someone from drowning), moral (e.g., standing up for what is right), and psychological courage (e.g., trying something new). Agreement on each of the major classifications (physical, moral, or psychological courage) ranged from 85% for psychological courage to 92% for moral courage. Disagreements were resolved by a third trained rater. Raters were blind to any numerical ratings made by participants. One way ANOVAs were run to see if type of action predicted mean ranks on the top strengths of courage.

The relationships between strengths/virtues and personal versus general courage were tested with general linear models, each with one within participants variable (type of courage rating: personal or general) and one between participants variable (strength). Main effects represent a relationship with overall courage; interactions represent a differential relationship with personal and general courage.

Results

Relative Ranks of Virtues and Strengths

The composite virtue of Courage ranked significantly higher than all other composite virtues in describing courageous actions (see Table 2). Table 3 presents data on the individual strengths. Three of the four strengths of Courage -- Persistence, Integrity, and Bravery -- had mean ranks placing them in the top five strengths, along with Hope, a strength of Transcendence, and Kindness, a strength of Humanity. Vitality, the fourth strength of Courage, ranked significantly lower than these five strengths, and was only ranked significantly higher than 8 of the remaining 18 strengths. Notably, Humor ranked significantly lower than any other strength.

Strengths and Type of Courageous Action

Post-hoc tests were conducted to see if the top five strengths and Vitality were differentially related to different types of courageous actions (Figure 1). There were 126 physically courageous

actions, 57 morally courageous actions, and 97 psychologically courageous actions. Eighteen actions did not fit these categories and were not included in the analyses discussed here. Because strengths are expressed as ranks, lower numbers indicate a greater degree of representativeness. There were significant effects of type of action obtained for Kindness ($F(2, 277) = 12.84, p < .01$), Integrity ($F(2, 277) = 3.46, p < .04$), Bravery ($F(2, 277) = 27.46, p < .01$), and Vitality ($F(2, 277) = 5.25, p < .01$). Kindness was more characteristic of physically courageous actions than of psychologically courageous actions ($t(221) = 5.03, p < .01$). Morally courageous actions exhibited more Kindness than psychologically courageous actions ($t(152) = 2.37, p < .02$). Integrity was more characteristic of morally than psychologically courageous actions ($t(152) = 2.74, p < .01$). Bravery was rated as more characteristic of morally courageous actions than of either physically courageous actions ($t(181) = 6.60, p < .01$) or psychologically courageous actions ($t(152) = 7.32, p < .01$). Finally, Vitality was significantly more characteristic of physically than psychologically courageous actions ($t(221) = 3.10, p < .01$). Both Hope ($F(2, 277) = 0.46, p = .63$) and Persistence ($F(2, 277) = 1.26, p = .29$) were not differentially related to type of action.²

Personal and General Courage

A main effect for the VIA composite virtue Courage (see Table 4) showed that Courage was associated with higher overall ratings of both personal and general courage, whereas Temperance was associated with lower ratings of both types of courage. A significant interaction was found for Justice and type of courage, such that increased Justice was associated with lower personal and higher general courage.

Among the individual strengths of Courage, there were main effects for Persistence and Vitality, both associated with higher ratings of both types of courage. The main effect of Vitality

was modified by a significant interaction with type of courage, indicating a stronger association with general than personal courage. There were no significant main effects or interactions for Bravery or Integrity.

Among the non-Courage strengths, Appreciation of Beauty and Excellence was associated with greater courage of both types whereas Humor and Prudence were associated with lower personal and general courage. Significant interactions were found for Fairness, Spirituality, and Kindness, associated with higher general courage; and for Self-Regulation and Leadership, associated with lower personal courage.

Discussion

We found support for necessary strengths of all types of courage, courage as a key virtue to express other strengths, differentiation of types of courage based on some strengths, and greater association of general courage with strengths compared to personal courage.

Of the VIA strengths of courage, bravery, persistence, and integrity ranked within the top five descriptors of courageous actions. Vitality ranked significantly lower, supporting Peterson and Seligman's (2004) speculation that it might be relatively context-free.

The inclusion of hope and kindness within the top five descriptors suggests that courage also represents a way of putting these virtues into action, thus supporting the idea of courage as a key virtue. This is particularly true for hope, which was characteristic of all types of courageous action.

Although we would not argue that courage and hope are one and the same construct, our participants rated hope as quite descriptive of courageous actions. Peterson and Seligman's (2004, p. 199) definition of courage -- "the exercise of will to accomplish goals in the face of opposition" -- shares much with Snyder's (2002, p. 249) definition of hope -- "the perceived

capability to derive pathways to desired goals, and motivate oneself via agency thinking to use those pathways”. Both courage and hope involve goals, active striving, and agency thinking or will. Persistence, the highest ranked strength of courage, may be facilitated by feelings of hopefulness. Hopefulness may also facilitate generation of initial and alternate pathways to the goals of courageous action (Snyder, 2002), and agency thinking (e.g. I can save this drowning person; I can stand up for what’s right).

Our participants rated kindness higher for physical and moral courage than for psychological courage. Trait kindness describes an individual who believes that “People who are suffering need compassion,” and “People in need require care” (Peterson & Seligman, 2004, p. 326). Physically and morally courageous actions were more frequently undertaken to help someone else than were psychologically courageous actions. MacIntyre (1981, p. 179) foreshadowed this link between kindness and courage when he said “If someone says that he cares for some individual, community, or cause, but is unwilling to risk harm or dangers on his, her, or its own behalf, he puts into question the genuineness of his care and concern. Courage...has a role in human life because of this connection with care and concern.” Thus, kindness as a descriptor of certain courageous actions seems well-suited.

The strengths of bravery, integrity, and kindness, although emerging as signature strengths of courageous actions, actually were differentially related to physical, psychological, and moral courage, suggesting that these strengths are not fundamental to all forms of courage. The finding that hope and persistence were not differentially related to physical, moral, or psychological courage is not especially surprising. Given the definitions of courage and hope provided earlier, courage involves seeking desired pathways or goals and, therefore, involves

hope. Similarly, as defined by Peterson and Seligman (2004), courage involves an act of will, part of persistence. Hopeful persistence may be the hallmark of courage.

The relationship between moral courage and both integrity and bravery makes conceptual sense. As defined by Peterson and Seligman (2004, p. 29) and by our questions, integrity involves “authenticity, honesty...taking responsibility for one’s feelings and actions.” Bravery involves “not shrinking from threat, challenge, difficulty, or pain.” Indeed, Peterson and Seligman specifically note that bravery may include physical bravery “but is not limited to it.” Typical acts of moral courage are those in which the person stands up for what she or he believes is right in the face opposition; or acting with integrity despite an obstacle or risk.

Importantly, courageous actions also differed in the extent to which they reflect general and personal courageousness. Although many of the strengths typify actions high in both personal and general courage, vitality, fairness, leadership, kindness, self-regulation and spirituality were all associated with more general courage and/or with less personal courage. These strengths may be particularly relevant for actions that would be courageous for anyone, not just the actor. Vitality, leadership, self-regulation, and spirituality may be related to confidence, which is related to general courage (Pury et al., 2007). General courage describes actions that would be courageous for anyone, in other words, have a clear noble purpose, whereas the goals of personal courage may be idiosyncratic to the individual. Additionally, the negative relationship between self-regulation and personal courage fits well with Pury et al.'s finding that personal courage is associated with higher fear; presumably, that fear needs to be regulated to act courageously (see Rachman, 1990).

The most highly ranked signature strengths of courageous actions were hope and persistence, given that they typified all three types of courageous actions. Although the other

emergent strengths were more typical of some types of courage than others, this may not diminish their utility in identifying courageous actions. The VIA system has been characterized as a positive counter to the *Diagnostic and Statistical Manual (DSM-IV TR*; American Psychiatric Association, 2000). Whereas the *DSM-IV* classifies weakness, the VIA system classifies strengths. The DSM-IV system allows some symptoms that are characteristic of many, but not all, disorders in a given category. For example, sleep disturbances characterize many (but not all) anxiety disorders. Just as some mental disorders share features with categories other than the one to which they are assigned, strengths may also share features of more than one virtue (Goodwin & Guze, 1996; Peterson & Seligman, 2004). Thus, like the *DSM*, the VIA may share both the heuristic value and the limitations of a system of hierarchical categories. That said, the data in the present study suggest that hope bears a stronger correspondence with courageous actions than most other strengths. Future research is needed that more explicitly explores this relationship between hope and courage.

Although contributing to the preliminary information that we have about the psychology of courage, this study also has some limitations. We developed our measure of strengths for this study; reliability and validity of the measure are unknown. The current VIA scale measures signature strengths in actors; the development of a standardized scale to measure signature strengths of actions may be useful in many areas of positive psychology.

The use of a college student sample limits our ability to generalize the results. Although research with samples of both older and younger individuals (Pury, Gregg, Sneed, & Van Der Vyver, 2006; Pury, Spearman, & Langway, 2006) substantiates the classifications of courageous actions used in this study, the strengths present in such actions may vary by age.

The courageous actions described by participants are retrospective and reflect self-reported recall of a single courageous action. As with any study using retrospective accounts, there is always the possibility of memory distortion. Features of the most cognitively accessible action may differ from those of other courageous actions less accessible to memory. Participants were primed to think of their past action as courageous and thus, perhaps, more noble, given the nature of our questions. Nevertheless, we feel that, because of the infancy of research on courage and our interest in establishing a strong conceptual foundation for courage, this set of limitations offers some strengths as well. It provides us with a methodology for deriving prototypical instances of courage that are the most memorable.

In summary, the VIA strength of persistence was consistently related to physical, moral, and psychological courage; with bravery, integrity, and kindness characteristic of at least one of these three types. Courage may be a key virtue for expressing hope and, in many instances, kindness. General and personal courage (Pury et al., 2007) were differentially related to several strengths; these relationships highlight the noble and socially valued nature of general courage. Future research should examine the extent to which these findings extend to individuals of different ages and life circumstances, as well as the extent to which individual differences in strengths are related to individual differences in courageous action. As Positive Psychology moves out of the lab and into strength-building strategies, it may pay to consider which strengths characterize courageous action. Strategies to enhance these strengths thus may build courage as well.

References

- American Psychiatric Association (2000). *Diagnostic and statistical manual of mental disorders: 4th edition, Text revision*. Washington D.C.: American Psychiatric Association.
- Goodwin, D. W., & Guze, S. B. (1996). *Psychiatric diagnosis* (5th ed.). New York: Oxford University Press.
- Lopez, S. J., O'Byrne, K.K., & Peterson, S. (2003). Profiling courage. In S. J. Lopez & C. R. Snyder (Eds.), *Positive psychological assessment: A handbook of models and measures* (pp. 185 – 197). Washington D.C.: American Psychological Association.
- MacIntyre, A. (1981). *After virtue*. Notre Dame, Indiana: University of Notre Dame Press.
- Miller, W. I., (2000). *The mystery of courage*. Cambridge, MA: Harvard University Press.
- Park, N., Peterson, C., & Seligman, M. E. P. (2004). Strengths of character and well-being. *Journal of Social & Clinical Psychology*, 23, 603-619.
- Peterson, C., & Seligman, M. E. P. (Eds.) (2004). *Character strengths and virtues: A handbook and classification*. New York: Oxford University Press.
- Pury, C. L. S., Kowalski, R. M., & Spearman, J. (2007). Distinctions between general and personal courage. *Journal of Positive Psychology (this issue)*.
- Pury, C. L. S., Gregg, K., Sneed, V., & Van Der Vyver, V. (2006). [Courageous acts in children]. Unpublished raw data.
- Pury, C. L. S., Spearman, J., & Langway, N. (2006). [Courageous acts in the elderly]. Unpublished raw data.
- Putman, D. (1997). Psychological courage. *Philosophy, Psychiatry, and Psychology*, 4, 1-11.
- Rachman, S. J. (1990). *Fear and courage*, 2nd editon. New York: W. H. Freeman and Co.
- Snyder, C. R. (2002). Hope theory: Rainbows in the mind. *Psychological Inquiry*, 13, 249-275.

Yearley, L. H. (1990). *Mencius and Aquinas: Theories of virtue and conceptions of courage*
SUNY series, Toward a comparative philosophy of Religions. Albany, N.Y.: State University
of New York Press.

Footnotes

¹ Address all correspondence to Cynthia Pury, Clemson University, Department of Psychology, 418 Brackett Hall, Clemson, SC 29634-1355, USA, or cpury@clemson.edu. We thank Kathleen Becht, Jacqueline Diehl, and Angela Hall, for their assistance with data coding.

² Results and interpretations were virtually identical using nonparametric techniques.

Table 1. Virtues, character strengths, and sample items (adapted from Peterson & Seligman, 2004).

Virtue	Character Strength	Sample Item
Courage	Bravery	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you NOT shrink from threat, challenge, difficulty, or pain?</i>
	Persistence	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you finish what you started?</i>
	Integrity	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you present yourself in a genuine way?</i>
	Vitality	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you feel alive and activated?</i>
Justice	Citizenship	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you work well as a member of a group or team?</i>
	Fairness	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you give everyone a fair chance?</i>
	Leadership	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you organize group activities and see that they happened?</i>
Humanity	Love	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you focus on a close, mutually sharing and caring relationship?</i>
	Kindness	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you help</i>

	<i>someone else?</i>
Social Intelligence	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you know what makes someone else tick?</i>
Temperance	
Forgiveness	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you give someone else a second chance?</i>
Humility	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you avoid seeking the spotlight for yourself?</i>
Prudence	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you avoid taking undue risks?</i>
Self-regulation	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you exercise self-discipline?</i>
Transcendence	
Appreciation of beauty and excellence	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you notice and appreciate excellence?</i>
Gratitude	<i>In taking this courageous action, were you aware of and thankful for good things that happened?</i>
Hope	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you believe that a good future is something that can be brought about?</i>
Humor	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you see the lighter side of the situation?</i>
Spirituality	<i>In taking this courageous action, did you focus on your beliefs about the higher purpose and meaning of</i>

the universe?

Wisdom and

Knowledge

Creativity

In taking this courageous action, did you think of a novel and productive way to do something?

Curiosity

In taking this courageous action, did you explore and discover?

Open-mindedness

In taking this courageous action, did you examine the issues from all sides?

Love of learning

In taking this courageous action, did you learn new knowledge?

Perspective

In taking this courageous action, did you look at the world in a way that made sense?

Table 2. Median and mean ranks of VIA composite virtues and Wilcoxon signed-rank z -scores comparing virtues

	Median	Mean		Wilcoxon Singned-Rank z-scores ¹				
Value	Rank	Rank (<i>SD</i>)						
				Humanity	Justice	Temperance	dence	
Courage	2	2.33	(1.37)	4.21*	8.08*	8.03*	10.96*	11.8*
Humanity	3	2.96	(1.80)	-	4.47*	2.73*	6.72*	7.94*
Justice	3	3.68	(1.77)		-	-1.91	2.91*	4.06*
Temperance	4	3.38	(1.49)			-	5.1*	6.67*
Transcendence	4	4.09	(1.47)				-	2.4
Wisdom and Knowledge	5	4.36	(1.55)					-

¹Similar results were found using t -tests.

* $p < .008$ (.05/6)

Table 3. Median and mean ranks of VIA strengths and Wilcoxon signed-rank z - scores comparing strengths.

Strength	Median Rank	Mean Rank (SD)	Wilcoxon Signed-Rank z -scores ¹									
			Kindness	Persistence	Integrity	Bravery	Love	Citizenship	Gratitude	Fairness	Vitality	Forgiveness and Mercy
Hope	4	7.82 (5.96)	0.49	-1.61	1.93	3.44*	4.11*	5.20*	5.42*	5.55*	6.39*	6.27*
Kindness	6	8.43 (8.52)	-	1.06	0.42	2.12	3.16	4.17*	3.15	3.92*	4.25*	4.69*
Persistence	7	7.04 (5.43)		-	2.99	4.76*	4.98*	6.65*	6.79*	6.98*	8.91*	7.40*
Integrity	7.5	8.49 (5.20)			-	2.01	3.01	4.36*	3.95*	4.76*	5.55*	5.77*
Bravery	9	9.47 (6.07)				-	1.45	2.69	1.83	2.73	3.18*	3.57*
Love	9	10.21 (7.59)					-	1.30	0.71	1.16	1.66	1.80
Citizenship	10.5	11.05 (7.47)						-	0.71	0.36	0.07	0.48
Gratitude	11	10.60 (6.90)							-	0.59	0.86	1.27
Fairness	11	10.95 (7.31)								-	0.58	0.88
Vitality	11	11.26 (6.72)									-	0.09
Forgiveness and Mercy	11	11.33 (6.84)										-
Humility	11	11.47 (6.11)										
Self-Regulation	12	11.53 (5.93)										
Perspective	12	11.80 (7.23)										
Social Intelligence	12	12.36 (5.80)										
Spirituality	14	13.11 (6.66)										
Prudence	14	13.46 (6.45)										
Love of Learning	15	13.53 (7.58)										
Curiosity	15	13.79 (6.97)										
Appreciation of Beauty and Excellence	15	14.06 (6.71)										
Creativity	15	14.16 (8.19)										
Open-Mindedness	16	14.67 (5.63)										
Leadership	17	15.16 (6.66)										
Humor	21	18.45 (5.67)										

¹Similar results were found using t -tests.* $p < .002$ (.05/24)

Table 3. (continued)

Strength	Wilcoxon Signed-Rank z-scores ¹												
	Humility	Self-Regulation	Perspective	Social Intelligence	Spirituality	Prudence	Love of Learning	Curiosity	Appreciation of Beauty and Excellence	Creativity	Open-Mindedness	Leadership	Humor
Hope	6.84*	7.02*	6.91*	8.22*	9.10*	9.46*	8.59*	9.45*	9.42*	9.37*	11.15*	10.47*	13.25*
Kindness	4.90*	4.95*	5.33*	6.34*	7.02*	7.23*	6.17*	6.59*	7.53*	7.56*	8.42*	9.56*	11.31*
Persistence	8.78*	8.42*	7.76*	9.58*	9.76*	10.09*	10.50*	10.97*	10.81*	10.03*	11.82*	11.70*	14.10*
Integrity	6.82*	6.58*	6.34*	7.91*	8.71*	9.53*	7.90*	8.40*	9.12*	8.81*	10.75*	10.29*	13.15*
Bravery	3.75*	4.43*	4.45*	6.15*	6.93*	7.44*	6.29*	6.94*	7.29*	7.05*	9.85*	8.88*	12.06*
Love	2.25	2.43	2.47	3.94*	5.07*	5.32*	4.97*	5.42*	6.09*	5.76*	7.09*	7.59*	11.17*
Citizenship	0.71	0.90	1.17	2.33	3.32*	3.92*	3.98*	4.44*	5.17*	4.58*	5.93*	8.36*	10.57*
Gratitude	1.20	1.74	1.87	3.08	4.59*	5.17*	5.21*	5.59*	6.34*	5.31*	7.14*	7.18*	12.19*
Fairness	0.85	0.94	1.22	2.30	3.65*	4.39*	3.92*	4.43*	5.19*	4.93*	6.60*	6.94*	10.63*
Vitality	0.18	0.62	1.16	2.16	3.17	3.60*	3.96*	4.88*	5.21*	4.53*	5.60*	6.73*	11.64*
Forgiveness and Mercy	0.01	0.28	0.69	1.93	3.28*	4.15*	3.51*	4.19*	4.58*	4.45*	6.28*	6.14*	10.57*
Humility	-	0.27	0.65	1.76	3.10	3.99*	3.38*	4.18*	4.65*	4.41*	6.10*	6.68*	11.01*
Self-Regulation		-	0.69	1.80	2.89	4.10*	3.53*	3.70*	4.71*	4.48*	6.51*	6.30*	11.60*
Perspective			-	0.85	2.51	2.96	2.62	3.29*	3.90*	3.58*	5.20*	5.71*	10.15*
Social Intelligence				-	1.94	2.14	2.14	2.94	3.43*	3.09	5.08*	5.41*	10.78*
Spirituality					-	0.54	0.92	1.42	2.07	1.67	2.80	3.38*	8.92*
Prudence						-	0.11	0.67	1.11	1.07	2.83	3.02	8.48*
Love of Learning							-	0.30	0.90	1.03	1.77	2.62	8.80*
Curiosity								-	0.63	0.50	1.46	2.31	9.47*
Appreciation of Beauty and Excellence									-	0.15	1.03	2.01	8.77*
Creativity										-	0.58	1.70	6.62*
Open-Mindedness											-	1.11	7.86*
Leadership												-	6.17*
Humor													-

¹Similar results were found using t-tests.* $p < .002$

Table 4. Relationship of Ranks of Composite Virtues and Strengths with Personal and General Courage.

	Personal		General Courage		Main Effect of			
	Courage				Virtue or Strength		Interaction	
	<i>r</i>	<i>p</i>	<i>r</i>	<i>p</i>	<i>F</i> (1, 296)	<i>p</i>	<i>F</i> (1, 296)	<i>p</i>
Composite Virtue								
Courage	-.10	.09	-.08	.15	3.84	.05	0.00	.98
Justice	.16	.01	-.13	.03	0.01	.94	15.29	.00
Humanity	-.04	.52	-.09	.12	0.39	.53	0.05	.82
Temperance	.12	.04	.11	.05	6.37	.01	0.01	.93
Transcendence	.03	.62	.05	.39	0.80	.37	0.11	.74
Wisdom	-.09	.12	.03	.66	0.39	.53	2.46	.12
Strength								
Bravery	.06	.32	-.01	.83	0.21	.65	0.89	.35
Persistence	-.14	.02	-.10	.09	6.75	.01	0.12	.73
Integrity	.04	.51	.05	.36	1.03	.31	0.08	.78
Vitality	-.04	.47	-.19	.00	7.29	.01	5.48	.02
Citizenship	.02	.76	-.06	.31	0.25	.62	1.24	.27
Fairness	.07	.24	-.14	.02	0.80	.37	8.83	.00
Leadership	.15	.01	-.09	.12	0.23	.63	11.21	.00
Social Intelligence	.06	.28	-.01	.91	0.32	.57	0.84	.36
Love	-.12	.04	.01	.83	1.11	.29	2.94	.09
Kindness	.03	.58	-.12	.04	1.08	.30	4.82	.03

Forgiveness	.06	.32	.05	.38	1.40	.24	0.00	1.00
Humility	.05	.35	.04	.50	1.02	.31	0.02	.89
Prudence	.09	.12	.09	.13	3.82	.05	0.01	.91
Self-Regulation	.20	.00	.00	.97	4.26	.04	7.35	.01
Appreciation of Beauty &								
Excellence	-.05	.41	-.14	.02	4.52	.03	2.07	.15
Gratitude	-.11	.05	.02	.70	0.83	.36	3.36	.07
Hope	-.04	.50	-.04	.52	0.69	.41	0.00	.97
Humor	.18	.00	.15	.01	13.70	.00	0.01	.91
Spirituality	.02	.78	-.14	.02	2.06	.15	5.21	.02
Open-Mindedness	-.03	.56	.07	.24	0.20	.66	2.15	.14
Creativity	-.03	.62	-.06	.34	0.88	.35	0.20	.66
Curiosity	-.10	.09	.04	.50	0.32	.57	3.56	.06
Love of Learning	-.01	.89	.00	.93	0.00	.98	0.03	.86
Perspective	.04	.48	-.05	.39	0.02	.88	1.62	.20

Note: Because strengths are represented as ranks, negative correlations indicate the strength is present to a *greater* degree.

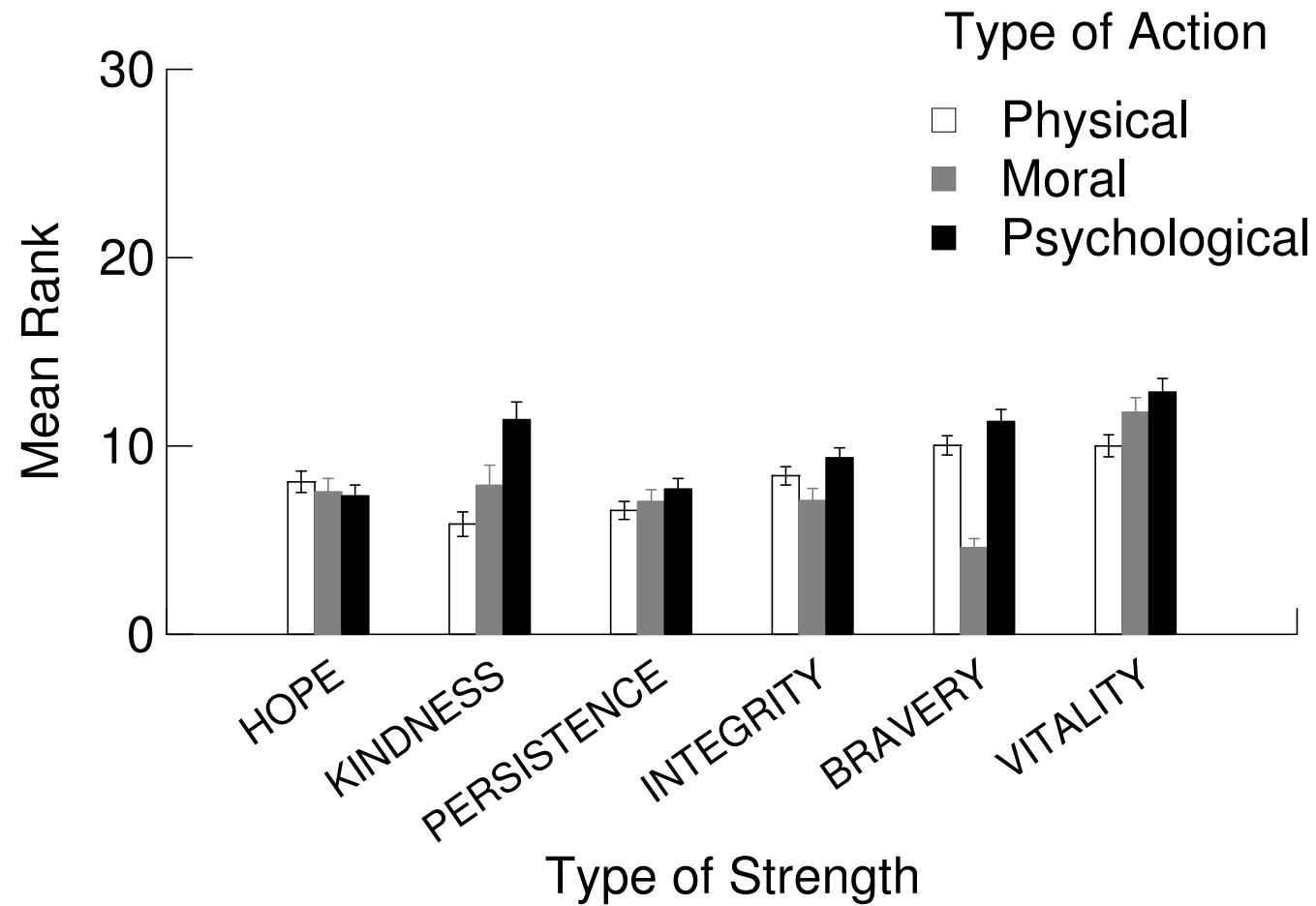


Figure 1. Mean ranks ($\pm$ 1 standard error) of top five strengths and vitality by type of action. Note: Because strengths are represented as ranks, lower numbers represent a greater degree of representativeness.